

D629

The Reflective Practitioner

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

Midway through a fifth-grade fractions lesson in a newly painted classroom, a teacher notices many blank faces during the explanation. She stops, pulls out fraction strips, and has students model the problem. Her class has 26 students and a class pet. What kind of reflection is she showing?

- A. It is not reflection, because she did not write anything down.
- B. Reflection-in-action.
- C. Reflection-on-action.
- D. Summative evaluation.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

After school, a teacher reviews exit tickets and decides to reteach a skill the next day. What kind of reflection is this?

- A. Peer observation.
- B. Norm-referenced assessment.
- C. Reflection-on-action.
- D. Reflection-in-action.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A high school history teacher with twelve years of experience believes her new debate format is working because it feels energetic. She teaches in a school with block scheduling. Which step best strengthens her reflection?

- A. Switch to traditional scheduling to reflect more easily.
- B. Write a longer journal entry about how the debates feel.
- C. Trust her impression, since she has twelve years of experience.
- D. Collect anonymous student feedback, invite a colleague to observe, and compare with research on structured debate.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher's reflection relies only on published research about a strategy. Which lens would add the most direct evidence about her own classroom?

- A.** Her students' perspective, such as a quick survey or exit comments.
- B.** More published research on the same strategy.
- C.** A national news article about the strategy.
- D.** No more lenses are needed once research supports a strategy.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A teacher writes in her reflection journal, which she keeps in a green notebook: "Today we did the lab. Students worked in groups of four. We ran out of time." She teaches at a school with a new science wing. How could she make this reflection more critical?

- A.** Ask why time ran out, what assumption about pacing was wrong, and what she will change next time.
- B.** Add more detail about what each group did.
- C.** Decide labs never work and stop doing them.
- D.** Write in a digital journal instead of the notebook.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which journal entry shows critical rather than descriptive reflection?

- A.** Peer-editing went fine as usual.
- B.** I felt tired today and the room was warm.
- C.** Students peer-edited for 20 minutes, then turned in drafts.
- D.** I assumed students knew how to peer-edit, but their comments were vague; next week I will model it with a sample.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A teacher says her math lesson went well: students were quiet, the room was neat, and a visiting parent volunteer praised the bulletin board. Exit tickets show 9 of 25 students solved the target problem. How should she judge the lesson?

- A. It went well, because 9 students succeeded.
- B. It went well, because the parent praised the room.
- C. Most students have not mastered the skill yet, so the lesson needs follow-up.
- D. It went well, because students were quiet and on task.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A middle school teacher who coaches the chess club wants to improve how she checks for understanding. She works in a district that recently adopted new laptops. Which goal is written best?

- A. By the end of the semester, I will use an every-student response check in at least four lessons a week and track exit-ticket mastery weekly.
- B. I will become better at checking for understanding.
- C. I will check every student's understanding every minute of every lesson.
- D. I will use the new laptops more.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher's goal reads: "I will use more small-group instruction in reading." Which SMART element is it most clearly missing?

- A. Nothing; any goal about instruction is SMART.
- B. A measurable target and a time frame.
- C. Relevance to teaching.
- D. A specific subject area.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A teacher wants to improve reading fluency for struggling third graders. A colleague with a popular teaching blog recommends a strategy she likes; the school library just got new beanbag chairs. Which approach best reflects evidence-based practice?

- A.** Let students read silently in the new beanbag chairs.
- B.** Use repeated reading with feedback, which has solid research support for fluency, and track progress.
- C.** Use any strategy, since all strategies work equally well.
- D.** Adopt the colleague's strategy because her blog is popular.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A teacher in a school with a strong arts program decides to try think-pair-share to raise participation. She plans to use it for three weeks. Her classroom has a new projector. What should she add to follow the action research cycle?

- A.** Use the new projector to display prompts.
- B.** Run it for six weeks instead of three.
- C.** Reflect first, then plan, then stop.
- D.** Collect participation data before and during the change, then reflect on the results before the next cycle.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A teacher asks a colleague to observe how she questions students during discussion. The colleague, who won a district award last year, arrives with a rating checklist and later tells the principal the lesson was "average." What went wrong?

- A.** Nothing; an award-winning colleague's rating is valuable.
- B.** The colleague should have used a longer rating checklist.
- C.** The observation should have been non-evaluative, focused on questioning, and kept between colleagues.
- D.** The teacher should have let the colleague choose the focus.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer B Concept 1

Midway through a fifth-grade fractions lesson ~~in a newly painted classroom~~, a teacher notices many blank faces during the explanation. She stops, pulls out fraction strips, and has students model the problem. ~~Her class has 26 students and a class pet.~~ What kind of reflection is she showing?

Target word: classify the reflection **Decides:** She adjusts during the lesson.

A	Absolute language	Reflection does not require writing.
B	Correct	She notices and adjusts in the moment.
C	Confusion set	That happens after the lesson.
D	Adjacent category	Judging learning at the end, not adjusting teaching mid-lesson.

2. Answer C Concept 1 • transfer

After school, a teacher reviews exit tickets and decides to reteach a skill the next day. What kind of reflection is this?

Target word: classify the reflection **Decides:** It happens after the lesson.

A	Adjacent category	No colleague is involved.
B	Confusion set	An assessment type, not a form of reflection.
C	Correct	Looking back after teaching to plan the next step.
D	Inverted operation	In-action happens during teaching.

3. Answer D Concept 2

A high school history teacher ~~with twelve years of experience~~ believes her new debate format is working because it feels energetic. She teaches in a school ~~with block scheduling~~. Which step best strengthens her reflection?

Target word: add perspectives **Decides:** Her judgment rests only on her own impression.

A	Adjacent category	Scheduling does not change the evidence base.
B	Dropped element	Still only her own lens.
C	Camouflage	Experience alone does not replace other lenses.
D	Correct	Adds students', colleagues', and research lenses.

4. Answer A Concept 2 • transfer

A teacher's reflection relies only on published research about a strategy. Which lens would add the most direct evidence about her own classroom?

Target word: reverse: find the missing lens **Decides:** Research is general; students see her class directly.

A	Correct	Students experience her teaching directly.
B	Inverted operation	Adds more of the lens she already uses.
C	Adjacent category	Not evidence from her classroom.
D	Absolute language	Research does not show how it works for her students.

5. Answer A Concept 3

A teacher writes in her reflection journal, ~~which she keeps in a green notebook~~: "Today we did the lab. Students worked in groups of four. We ran out of time." ~~She teaches at a school with a new science wing.~~ How could she make this reflection more critical?

Target word: move from descriptive to critical **Decides:** The entry only recounts events.

A	Correct	Critical reflection analyzes causes and plans change.
B	Dropped element	More description is still description.
C	Absolute language	A sweeping conclusion without analysis.
D	Camouflage	The format does not change the depth.

6. Answer D Concept 3 · transfer

Which journal entry shows critical rather than descriptive reflection?

Target word: reverse: pick the critical entry **Decides:** It questions an assumption and names a change.

A	Dropped element	No evidence, cause, or plan.
B	Adjacent category	Personal state, not analysis of practice.
C	Confusion set	Only describes what happened.
D	Correct	Tests an assumption, uses evidence, and plans a change.

7. Answer C Concept 4

A teacher says her math lesson went well: students were quiet, the room was neat, and ~~a visiting parent volunteer praised the bulletin board~~. Exit tickets show 9 of 25 students solved the target problem. How should she judge the lesson?

Target word: judge by learning evidence **Decides:** Only 36% (9/25) showed mastery.

A	Wrong stem number	9 is a count of successes; 16 of 25 did not succeed.
B	Camouflage	Irrelevant to learning.
C	Correct	Only 9/25 = 36% succeeded; learning evidence outweighs calm behavior.
D	Confusion set	Compliance is not learning.

8. Answer A Concept 5

A middle school teacher ~~who coaches the chess club~~ wants to improve how she checks for understanding. She works ~~in a district that recently adopted new laptops~~. Which goal is written best?

Target word: best SMART goal **Decides:** Specific, measurable, and time-bound.

A	Correct	Specific action, measure, and time frame.
B	Dropped element	No measure or time frame.
C	Absolute language	Not achievable.
D	Camouflage	Focuses on the device, not the practice or a measure.

9. Answer B Concept 5 • transfer

A teacher's goal reads: "I will use more small-group instruction in reading." Which SMART element is it most clearly missing?

Target word: reverse: find the missing elements **Decides:** No measure and no deadline.

A	Absolute language	Topic alone does not make a goal SMART.
B	Correct	"More" is not measurable and no date is set.
C	Adjacent category	Small-group reading is clearly relevant.
D	Confusion set	Reading is named.

10. Answer B Concept 6

A teacher wants to improve reading fluency for struggling third graders. A colleague ~~with a popular teaching blog~~ recommends a strategy she likes; ~~the school library just got new beanbag chairs~~. Which approach best reflects evidence-based practice?

Target word: choose an evidence-based practice **Decides:** Strong research support and fit to the goal.

A	Adjacent category	Independent silent reading alone has weak evidence for struggling readers' fluency.
B	Correct	Researched, matched to fluency, and monitored.
C	Absolute language	Strategies differ in evidence.
D	Camouflage	Popularity is not evidence.

11. Answer D Concept 7

A teacher ~~in a school with a strong arts program~~ decides to try think-pair-share to raise participation. She plans to use it for three weeks. ~~Her classroom has a new projector~~. What should she add to follow the action research cycle?

Target word: missing step in the cycle **Decides:** No data collection or reflection is planned.

A	Camouflage	A tool detail, not a cycle step.
B	Wrong stem number	Length does not replace data and reflection.
C	Inverted operation	Scrambles the cycle and leaves out acting and observing.
D	Correct	Observe and reflect complete the cycle.

12. Answer C Concept 8

A teacher asks a colleague to observe how she questions students during discussion. The colleague, ~~who won a district award last year~~, arrives with a rating checklist and later tells the principal the lesson was "average." What went wrong?

Target word: flaw in peer observation **Decides:** The visit became evaluative and ignored the chosen focus.

A	Camouflage	The award does not justify rating a growth visit.
B	Inverted operation	More rating makes it more evaluative.
C	Correct	Growth-focused observation is descriptive and teacher-directed.
D	Adjacent category	The teacher chooses the focus in growth observation.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	4	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	8	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	4	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	6	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	5	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	7	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Reflection-in-action vs. reflection-on-action	Reflection-in-action is adjusting in the moment while teaching; reflection-on-action is looking back afterward to learn from what happened.	Thinking all reflection happens after the lesson.	Whether the adjustment happens during or after the lesson.
2	Multiple lenses on practice	Critical reflection checks teaching through several lenses: your own experience, students' eyes, colleagues' perceptions, and research.	Relying only on your own impressions.	A teacher drawing conclusions from one viewpoint.
3	Descriptive vs. critical reflection	Descriptive reflection recounts what happened; critical reflection asks why, tests assumptions, and names what to change.	Mistaking a detailed account of a lesson for deep reflection.	A journal entry that retells events but draws no conclusions.
4	Student evidence drives reflection	Judge a lesson by evidence of student learning, not by how smoothly it felt or how busy students looked.	Equating a calm, on-task class with learning.	A teacher saying a lesson "went well" without learning data.
5	SMART growth goals	Professional growth goals should be specific, measurable, achievable, relevant, and time-bound.	Writing vague goals like "become a better teacher."	Choosing the best-written goal.
6	Choosing evidence-based practices	Pick practices with strong research support that also fit your students and your goal.	Adopting what is popular or what a colleague likes.	A choice between a trendy strategy and a researched one.
7	The action research cycle	Plan a change, act, observe the results with data, and reflect before planning the next cycle.	Trying a change and judging it without collecting data.	A teacher trying a new strategy.
8	Peer observation as a growth tool	Growth-focused peer observation is non-evaluative and centered on a focus the teacher chose, with descriptive notes.	Turning peer visits into informal ratings or general praise.	A colleague visiting to help, not to evaluate.

Course scope (public description): The Reflective Practitioner defines what reflective teaching is and how accomplished teachers reflect meaningfully on their pedagogical choices to improve their practice. During this course, candidates will examine their teaching to determine how they can more effectively plan, facilitate, and evaluate learning. Candidates will also develop a professional growth plan and incorporate evidence-based practices that support the achievement of their professional goals. There are no prerequisites for this course.